SSC GD Constable 2022 question paper with answers

12 January 2023 · Shift 3

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 14 of the paper's 80 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20230219070003/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Write_up_Constable_GD_2022_18022023.pdf

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning 15 questions

Q.1

Seven people D, E,F,G,H,I and J are sitting in a straight row, facing north. Only three people sit between D and H. E sits fourth to the left of J. Only D is between E and I. J sits third to the right of F. Who sits at the second position from the right end of the row?

(A) E
(B) D
(C) H
(D) I

Q.2

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 6, 10, 19, 35, ? , 96

(A) 70
(B) 68
(C) 60
(D) 74

Q.3

Three statements are given followed by three conclusions numbered 1, 2 and 3. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some shoes are slippers. Some slippers are socks. All socks are sandals. Conclusions: 1. Some sandals are shoes. 2. Some sandals are slippers. 3. Some socks are shoes.

(A) Only conclusion 2 follows
(B) Only conclusions 1 and 2 follow
(C) Only conclusions 2 and 3 follow
(D) Only conclusion 3 follows

Q.4

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 18 : 4 :: 36 : 16 :: 27 : ?

(A) 8
(B) 9
(C) 7
(D) 10

Q.5

Six friends (Aman, Biplab, Chirantan, Divya, Elizabeth and Firoz) are sitting around a circular table facing the centre. Aman sits third to the left of Biplab. Chirantan is an immediate neighbour of Aman. Elizabeth sits second to the right of Divya. Chirantan is not an immediate neighbour of Divya. Who sits between Aman and Elizabeth?

(A) Firoz
(B) Divya
(C) Chirantan
(D) Biplab

Q.6

In a certain code language, ‘fruit hat string’ is coded as ‘worm bee wheel’, ‘hat fruit’ is coded as ‘bee worm’, and ‘string hat’ is coded as ‘wheel bee’. What is the code word for ‘fruit’?

(A) bee
(B) worm
(C) wheel
(D) hat

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must not be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word.) Virology : Viruses :: Cardiology : ?

(A) Skull
(B) Head
(C) Lungs
(D) Heart

Q.10

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the below equation mathematically correct? 120 + 18 × 40 – 10 ÷ 20 = 172

(A) – and +
(B) + and ×
(C) + and ÷
(D) ÷ and –

Q.11

Which of the following letter-clusters will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? GMPJ, HLOK, IKNL, JJMM, ?

(A) KKMN
(B) LKLN
(C) LKLO
(D) KILN

Q.12

In a certain code language, ‘PARENT’ is written as ‘148’ and ‘WRANGLE’ is written as ‘160’.How will ‘GRANTED’ be written in that language?

(A) 134
(B) 67
(C) 138
(D) 69

Q.13

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 20, 24, 33, ?, 107, 228, 397

(A) 82
(B) 86
(C) 29
(D) 58

Q.14

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? BDGF, ACFE, ? , YADC, XZCB

(A) ZBED
(B) YBED
(C) ZAFE
(D) YAFD

Q.16

Which option represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in the English dictionary? 1 culture 2 cult 3 cultivate 4 cupid 5 cumin

(A) 2,3,1,5,4
(B) 3,2,1,4,5
(C) 2,3,1,4,5
(D) 2,1,3,5,4

Q.18

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. IFHO : LCEK :: HIJK : KFGG :: QLGK : ?

(A) ITHD
(B) TIDG
(C) ITDH
(D) TIHD

Q.20

A is married to Z. Z has 3 children L, M and N. Z is not the father of the children. P is the mother of A. L is the husband of D. M has 2 daughters H and J. How is Z related to P?

(A) Daughter
(B) Daughter in law
(C) Son
(D) Mother

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness 19 questions

Q.1

Which is NOT the correct statement about the Governor?

(A) He appoints the Chief Minister and other Ministers.
(B) He has the power to grant pardons, reprieves and forgive the death penalty of a person
(C) He may issue Ordinances under certain circumstances
(D) The state executive power is vested with the Governor.

Q.3

In which year did Congress and Muslim League signed the Lucknow pact?

(A) 1914
(B) 1916
(C) 1910
(D) 1912

Q.4

_____ can be visualized as a functional unit of nature, where living organisms interact among themselves and also with the surrounding physical environment.

(A) A family
(B) A universe
(C) An ecosystem
(D) A herd

Q.5

What is the Full Form of BCCI?

(A) Board of Cricket Control
(B) Board of Control of Cycling in India
(C) Board of Control for Cricket in India
(D) Basic Cricket Control Board

Q.6

India's first five-year plan was launched in _____.

(A) 1901
(B) 1961
(C) 1971
(D) 1951

Q.7

Apart from the Cash Reserve Ratio, banks are also required to keep some reserves in liquid form in the short term, referred as _____

(A) Statutory Liquidity Repo
(B) State Liquidity Ratio
(C) Statutory Liquidity Ratio
(D) Statutory License Ratio

Q.8
In which year was the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) passed?

(A) 1993
(B) 2005
(C) 1995
(D) 2000

Q.9
President of India appointed senior advocate _____ as the next Attorney-General for India in September 2022.

(A) Ram Jethmalani
(B) R Venkataramani
(C) Pravin Anand
(D) Jasbina Ahluwalia

Q.10
Who was the prime minister of India when the fundatmental duties were included in the Indian constitution?

(A) Indira Gandhi
(B) Rajiv Gandhi
(C) Manmohan Singh
(D) Jawaharlal Nehru

Q.11
Green Revolution mainly revolves around _____.

(A) Rain harvesting
(B) Natural Vegetation
(C) High Yield Variety Programme
(D) Use of Natural Fertilizers

Q.12
Who was the coach of the U-19 Indian cricket team at the ICC U19 World Cup 2022?

(A) Ajit Agarkar
(B) Mohammed Kaif
(C) Anil Kumble
(D) Hrishikesh Kanitkar

Q.13
Thiruvathira festival is mainly celebrated in which of these states?

(A) Odisha
(B) Assam
(C) Punjab
(D) Kerala

Q.14
What is used for manufacturing synthetic fibers, synthetic rubber, plastics, dye-stuffs, drugs and pharmaceuticals?

(A) sugar cane
(B) petrochemicals
(C) natural gas
(D) coal

Q.15
Which of the following is NOT a sedimentary rock?

(A) Granite
(B) Sand stone
(C) Loess
(D) Shale

Q.16
Who has been appointed as the Revenue Secretary by the Indian government in October 2022?

(A) S.S Nakul
(B) Sanjay Malhotra
(C) Tarun Bajaj
(D) Ajay Bhushan Pandey

Q.17
Who presented the Criminal Procedure (Identification) Bill, 2022 on March 28 in Lok Sabha?

(A) Meenakshi Lekhi
(B) Ajay Kumar Mishra
(C) Krishan Pal
(D) Rao Inderjit Singh

Q.18
According to Megasthenes, the guards of Chandragupta rode _____ decorated with gold and silver during royal processions.

(A) elephants
(B) unicorns
(C) bulls
(D) horses

Q.19
Kalbelia is a famous folk dance of which Indian state?

(A) Odisha
(B) Bihar
(C) West Bengal
(D) Rajasthan

Q.20
Which of the following festivals celebrates the harvest season in August – September?

(A) Onam
(B) Makar Sankranti
(C) Lohri
(D) Baisakhi

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics 12 questions

Q.6
The fourth proportional to 3, 12, 14 is:

(A) 35
(B) 28
(C) 56
(D) 49

Q.7
An iron ball of radius 21 cm is melted and recast into spherical balls of radius 7 cm. Find the number of spherical balls.

(A) 9
(B) 21
(C) 18
(D) 27

Q.8
Find the sum of the digits of the smallest 6-digit number divisible by 18, 24 and 25.

(A) 12
(B) 10
(C) 15
(D) 9

Q.10
A vegetable vendor does his sales using a weight which is 12% less than the actual weight and earns a profit of 32% on the cost price. Find the total profit percentage?

(A) 44%
(B) 40%
(C) 50%
(D) 45%

Q.11
A and B can complete a work in 18 days and 36 days respectively. They work together for 8 days and then A leaves. How many days will B take to complete the rest of the work?

(A) 15
(B) 12
(C) 18
(D) 10

Q.12
What is the average of the first 10 multiples of 3?

(A) 16.5
(B) 14.5
(C) 15.5
(D) 11.5

Q.13

If the price of potatoes increases by 10 percent, then by how much percent a user has to cut down on his consumption of potatoes, so that the expenditure on potatoes remains unchanged?

(A) 16.4 percent
(B) 15.8 percent
(C) 12.5 percent
(D) 9.1 percent

Q.14

The current value of a car is ₹ 8,50,000 and its value is depreciating at the rate of 10% per annum. What will be its value (in ₹) after 4 years?

(A) 5,47,685
(B) 5,57,685
(C) 5,67,685
(D) 5,57,865

Q.15

What is the faulty weight used by a dishonest shopkeeper instead of the original weight of 1 kg to get a profit of 25%?

(A) 250 grams
(B) 800 grams
(C) 640 grams
(D) 980 grams

Q.16

A, B, and C can complete a work in 30, 60, and 120 days respectively. A left the work 10 days before the work was completed and B left 5 days before the completion of the work. Find the number of days required to complete the whole work.

(A) 170/7 days
(B) 144/7 days
(C) 89/7 days
(D) 190/7 days

Q.17

Mr. Sharma spends 15% of his total income on rent and 75% of the remaining part on other expenses and still saves Rs.1,700 monthly. What is his monthly income?

(A) Rs.8,000
(B) Rs.7,000
(C) Rs.7,500
(D) Rs.8,500

Q.20

Arjun rides his bike 10 km at an average speed of 30 km/h, and again travels 14 km at an average speed of 25 km/h. What is his average speed (approx.) for the entire trip?

(A) 27.68 km/h
(B) 26.87 km/h
(C) 29.81 km/h
(D) 28.76 km/h

Part-D-English 20 questions

Q.1

Select the word segment that substitutes (replaces) the bracketed word segment correctly and completes the sentence meaningfully. When the last Tsar of Russia (were arrested by revolutionaries), he and his family were hiding at a palace near St. Petersburg; now that palace is open to tourists.

(A) is arresting from revolutionaries
(B) was arrested by revolutionaries
(C) were arrest by revolutionaries
(D) is arrested by revolutionaries

Q.2

Select the correct word for the blanks in the given sentence. Sushant is a very _____ person and the _____ of first ten natural numbers is 5.5.

(A) clever
(B) mean
(C) honest
(D) shrewd

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Consistent

(A) Evolve
(B) Change
(C) Constant
(D) Alter

Q.4

Select the correct word for the blanks in the given sentence. The tree has a brown _____ and the dogs _____ at the stranger.

(A) tail
(B) sound
(C) trunk
(D) bark

Q.5

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word given below to fill in the blank in the following sentence. Pamper My grandmother said, “Don’t _____ the kid. He will get spoiled”.

(A) bend
(B) comfortable
(C) attend
(D) coddle

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. This is an “olden” building of historical importance.

(A) ancient
(B) elder
(C) older
(D) very older

Q.7

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The peon / was brought / a cup of / coffee for Naina.

(A) coffee for Naina
(B) a cup of
(C) was brought
(D) The peon

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Earn

(A) Receive
(B) Lose
(C) Accord
(D) Surrender

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Fit as a fiddle

(A) In good health
(B) Limited in scope
(C) Emergency situation
(D) To be of perfect size

Q.10

The sentence given below has one misspelt word. Spot the INCORRECTLY spelt word and select its correct spelling. Some diseases are due to neurologikal disorders.

(A) Newrologecal
(B) Neurological
(C) Neurologecal
(D) Newrological

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The private _____ has contributed immensely to the country’s economy.

(A) division
(B) segment
(C) section
(D) sector

Q.12

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Take it with a grain of salt

(A) To calculate things with utmost precision

(B) To misinterpret that the real situation is hidden

(C) To understand that something is likely to be untrue

(D) To imagine that someone is working against you

Q.13

Fill in the blank by selecting the meaningful and correctly spelt word from the given options. Nowadays, the police get a long _____ of drug peddlers every day.

(A) list

(B) lest

(C) leest

(D) least

Q.14

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Hope

(A) Despair

(B) Promise

(C) Craving

(D) Fantasy

Q.15

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Generous

(A) Liberal

(B) Free

(C) Selfish

(D) Selfless

Q.16

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. An initiative has been (1) _____ in the educational reform sector in form of Social and Emotional Learning (SEL). This novel (2) _____ helps students to understand and manage their own emotions. The students (3) _____ and learn in a constructive manner. This concept (4) _____ momentum with the publication of the best seller by Daniel Goleman titled 'Emotional Intelligence: Why it can matter more than IQ'. It (5) _____ the enhancement of the given competencies: speaking and listening, cooperative skills and problem solving.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) discovered

(B) started

(C) reckoned

(D) established

Q.17

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. An initiative has been (1) _____ in the educational reform sector in form of Social and Emotional Learning (SEL). This novel (2) _____ helps students to understand and manage their own emotions. The students (3) _____ and learn in a constructive manner. This concept (4) _____ momentum with the publication of the best seller by Daniel Goleman titled 'Emotional Intelligence: Why it can matter more than IQ'. It (5) _____ the enhancement of the given competencies: speaking and listening, cooperative skills and problem solving.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) intention

(B) application

(C) concept

(D) experiment

Q.18

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. An initiative has been (1) _____ in the educational reform sector in form of Social and Emotional Learning (SEL). This novel (2) _____ helps students to understand and manage their own emotions. The students (3) _____ and learn in a constructive manner. This concept (4) _____ momentum with the publication of the best seller by Daniel Goleman titled 'Emotional Intelligence: Why it can matter more than IQ'. It (5) _____ the enhancement of the given competencies: speaking and listening, cooperative skills and problem solving.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) act
(B) affect
(C) mingle
(D) interact

Q.19

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. An initiative has been (1) _____ in the educational reform sector in form of Social and Emotional Learning (SEL). This novel (2) _____ helps students to understand and manage their own emotions. The students (3) _____ and learn in a constructive manner. This concept (4) _____ momentum with the publication of the best seller by Daniel Goleman titled 'Emotional Intelligence: Why it can matter more than IQ'. It (5) _____ the enhancement of the given competencies: speaking and listening, cooperative skills and problem solving.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) gratified
(B) gained
(C) relieved
(D) profited

Q.20

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. An initiative has been (1) _____ in the educational reform sector in form of Social and Emotional Learning (SEL). This novel (2) _____ helps students to understand and manage their own emotions. The students (3) _____ and learn in a constructive manner. This concept (4) _____ momentum with the publication of the best seller by Daniel Goleman titled 'Emotional Intelligence: Why it can matter more than IQ'. It (5) _____ the enhancement of the given competencies: speaking and listening, cooperative skills and problem solving.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) incorporates
(B) influences
(C) compares
(D) merges

Answer key

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(A)**
Q.16 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**			

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(A)**					

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics

Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**

Part-D-English

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**				

Explanations

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) H

E is fourth to the left of J and J third to the right of F; with E, D and I side by side, the only order that seats everyone is I, D, E, F, G, H, J from the left, with three people between D and H. H is second from the right.

Q.2 · Answer (C) 60

The differences are 4, 9, 16, 25, 36, the squares of 2 to 6: 35 + 25 = 60 and 60 + 36 = 96.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Only conclusion 2 follows

Some slippers are socks and all socks are sandals, so some slippers are sandals: 2 follows. The shoes that are slippers need not be the slippers that are socks, so 1 and 3 do not follow.

Q.4 · Answer (B) 9

The second number is the square of the first divided by 9: 18 ÷ 9 = 2 and $2^2 = 4$; 36 ÷ 9 = 4 and $4^2 = 16$. So 27 ÷ 9 = 3 and $3^2 = 9$.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Chirantan

Aman, third to the left of Biplab, sits opposite him. With Elizabeth second to the right of Divya and Chirantan next to Aman but not to Divya, the only arrangement, going round to the left from Biplab, is Divya, Firoz, Aman, Chirantan, Elizabeth. Chirantan sits between Aman and Elizabeth.

Q.6 · Answer (B) worm

'Hat' is in all three phrases and 'bee' in all three codes, so hat = bee. Then 'hat fruit' = 'bee worm' gives fruit = worm (and string = wheel).

Q.8 · Answer (D) Heart

Virology is the study of viruses; cardiology is the study of the heart.

Q.10 · Answer (D) ÷ and –

After interchanging ÷ and –: 120 + 18 × 40 ÷ 10 – 20 = 120 + 72 – 20 = 172.

Q.11 · Answer (D) KILN

The first letters run G, H, I, J, K; the second M, L, K, J, I; the third P, O, N, M, L; the fourth J, K, L, M, N. The next cluster is KILN.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 138

Each word is coded as twice the sum of its letters' places in the alphabet: PARENT = 16 + 1 + 18 + 5 + 14 + 20 = 74 → 148 and WRANGLE = 80 → 160. GRANTED = 7 + 18 + 1 + 14 + 20 + 5 + 4 = 69 → 138.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 58

The differences are the squares of the primes 2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13: 4, 9, 25, 49, 121, 169. So 33 + 25 = 58, and 58 + 49 = 107.

Q.14 · Answer (A) ZBED

Each letter moves one place back each time: B, A, Z, Y, X; D, C, B, A, Z; G, F, E, D, C; F, E, D, C, B. The missing cluster is ZBED.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 2,3,1,5,4

In dictionary order: cult (2), cultivate (3), culture (1), cumin (5), cupid (4). 'Cult' is the shortest, 'culti' comes before 'cultu', and 'cum' before 'cup'.

Q.18 · Answer (B) TIDG

The letters move +3, –3, –3, –4: I → L, F → C, H → E, O → K and H → K, I → F, J → G, K → G. So QLGK → TIDG.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Daughter in law

Z is not the father of the children, so Z is their mother and A's wife. P is A's mother, so Z is P's daughter-in-law.

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) He has the power to grant pardons, reprieves and forgive the death penalty of a person

SSC's key gives this statement, on the textbook reading of Articles 72 and 161: only the President can pardon a death sentence, while a Governor can grant pardons, reprieves, respites and remissions and can suspend, remit or commute a sentence, a death sentence included, but cannot pardon one. A Supreme Court ruling of August 2021, on Article 161 and Section 433A of the CrPC, was widely reported as letting a Governor pardon prisoners including those on death row, but the other three statements are plainly correct (Articles 164, 213 and 154).

Q.3 · Answer (B) 1916

In the Lucknow Pact of December 1916 the Congress and the Muslim League agreed on joint demands for self-government, and the Congress accepted separate electorates for Muslims.

Q.4 · Answer (C) An ecosystem

This is NCERT's definition of an ecosystem: the living organisms of an area and the physical environment they interact with, working as one unit.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Board of Control for Cricket in India

BCCI stands for the Board of Control for Cricket in India, the body that runs cricket in the country.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 1951

India's First Five-Year Plan ran from 1951 to 1956 and gave priority to agriculture.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Statutory Liquidity Ratio

Besides the cash reserve ratio, held with the RBI, banks must keep a set share of their deposits in liquid assets such as cash, gold and approved government securities: the Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR).

Q.8 · Answer (B) 2005

The National Rural Employment Guarantee Act was passed in 2005 and renamed after Mahatma Gandhi in 2009; when the exam was held (January 2023) it guaranteed a rural household 100 days of wage employment a year.

Q.9 · Answer (B) R Venkataramani

In September 2022 the President appointed R Venkataramani Attorney General for India for three years from 1 October 2022, succeeding K K Venugopal.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Indira Gandhi

The Fundamental Duties (Part IVA, Article 51A) were added by the 42nd Amendment of 1976, on the Swaran Singh Committee's recommendation, when Indira Gandhi was Prime Minister.

Q.11 · Answer (C) High Yield Variety Programme

The Green Revolution of the mid-1960s rested on the High Yielding Varieties Programme (1966): high-yielding seeds of wheat and rice, used with fertilisers, pesticides and irrigation.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Hrishikesh Kanitkar

Hrishikesh Kanitkar was head coach of the India team, captained by Yash Dhull, that won the ICC Under-19 World Cup 2022 in the West Indies.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Kerala

Thiruvathira is a festival of Kerala, held in the Malayalam month of Dhanu (December-January), when women perform the Thiruvathirakali dance.

Q.14 · Answer (B) petrochemicals

Petrochemicals, obtained from crude oil and natural gas, are the raw material for synthetic fibres, synthetic rubber, plastics, dyes, drugs and pharmaceuticals.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Granite

Granite is an igneous rock, formed from magma that cooled slowly below the surface. Sandstone and shale are sedimentary rocks, and loess, fine silt laid down by the wind, is grouped with them.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Sanjay Malhotra

In October 2022 the government named Sanjay Malhotra, then Secretary of the Department of Financial Services, officer on special duty in the Department of Revenue, to become Revenue Secretary when Tarun Bajaj retired on 30 November 2022; he took charge on 1 December 2022.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Ajay Kumar Mishra

Ajay Kumar Mishra, Minister of State for Home Affairs, introduced the Criminal Procedure (Identification) Bill, 2022 in the Lok Sabha on 28 March 2022, to replace the Identification of Prisoners Act, 1920.

Q.18 · Answer (A) elephants

Megasthenes, the Greek envoy at Chandragupta Maurya's court, described royal processions in which the emperor's guards rode elephants decorated with gold and silver.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Rajasthan

Kalbelia is the dance of Rajasthan's Kalbelia community of snake charmers; UNESCO inscribed the Kalbelia folk songs and dances of Rajasthan on its intangible heritage list in 2010.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Onam

Onam, the harvest festival of Kerala, falls in the Malayalam month of Chingam (August-September). Makar Sankranti and Lohri come in January and Baisakhi in April.

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics

Q.6 · Answer (C) 56

3 : 12 = 14 : x, so x = 12 × 14 ÷ 3 = 56.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 27

Volumes go as the cube of the radius: $(21/7)^3 = 3^3 = 27$ balls.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 9

LCM(18, 24, 25) = $2^3 \times 3^2 \times 5^2$ = 1800. 100000 ÷ 1800 = 55.6, so the smallest 6-digit multiple is 56 × 1800 = 100800, whose digits add up to 1 + 8 = 9.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 50%

He gives 880 g for every 1,000 g he charges for, at 1.32 times the cost price: 1.32 × 1000/880 = 1.5, so his total profit is 50%.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 12

Together they do 1/18 + 1/36 = 1/12 of the work a day, so 8/12 = 2/3 in 8 days. B does the remaining 1/3 in 36 ÷ 3 = 12 days.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 16.5

The multiples 3, 6, ..., 30 are evenly spaced, so their average is (3 + 30)/2 = 16.5.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 9.1 percent

Consumption must fall by 10/110 × 100 = 9.09%, about 9.1 percent, since 1.1 × (1 − 1/11) = 1.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 5,57,685

₹8,50,000 × 0.9^4 = ₹8,50,000 × 0.6561 = ₹5,57,685.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 800 grams

Selling at the cost price, the shopkeeper gains 25% if he gives w grams for every 1,000: 1000/w = 1.25, so w = 800 grams.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 170/7 days
If the work takes T days, A works T – 10, B T – 5 and C T days: (T – 10)/30 + (T – 5)/60 + T/120 = 1. Multiplying by 120: 4T – 40 + 2T – 10 + T = 120, so 7T = 170 and T = 170/7 days.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Rs.8,000
After rent he has 85% of his income and saves a quarter of it: 0.85 × 0.25 = 0.2125 of the income = ₹1,700, so the income is 1,700 ÷ 0.2125 = ₹8,000.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 26.87 km/h
The 24 km take 10/30 + 14/25 = 1/3 + 14/25 = 67/75 hour, so the average speed is 24 × 75/67 = 1800/67 ≈ 26.87 km/h.

Part-D-English

Q.1 · Answer (B) was arrested by revolutionaries
The singular subject 'the last Tsar' takes 'was', and the past passive matches 'were hiding': 'was arrested by revolutionaries'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) mean
'Mean' fits both blanks: a mean person is unkind or stingy, and the mean (average) of 1 to 10 is 55/10 = 5.5.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Constant
'Consistent' means unchanging: 'constant'. 'Evolve', 'change' and 'alter' are all verbs of changing, the opposite idea.

Q.4 · Answer (D) bark
'Bark' fits both blanks: the outer covering of a tree trunk, and the sound a dog makes.

Q.5 · Answer (D) coddle
To 'pamper' or 'coddle' a child is to indulge and over-protect it, which spoils it.

Q.6 · Answer (A) ancient
'Olden' is used only in set phrases such as 'olden days'; a building of historical importance is 'ancient'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) was brought
The peon did the bringing, so the verb must be active: 'The peon brought a cup of coffee for Naina.'

Q.8 · Answer (A) Receive
To 'earn' is to receive money or reward in return for work. 'Lose' and 'surrender' are near opposites, and 'accord' means to grant.

Q.9 · Answer (A) In good health
'Fit as a fiddle' means in very good health.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Neurological
The correct spelling is 'neurological', with 'eu' and a 'c': relating to the nerves and the nervous system.

Q.11 · Answer (D) sector
The 'private sector' is the part of the economy run by private businesses rather than by the government.

Q.12 · Answer (C) To understand that something is likely to be untrue
To 'take something with a grain of salt' is to doubt it, accepting that it may not be wholly true.

Q.13 · Answer (A) list
The police get a long 'list' of names. 'Lest' means for fear that, 'least' is the superlative of 'little', and 'leest' is not a word.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Despair
The opposite of 'hope' is 'despair', the complete loss of hope.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Selfish
The opposite of 'generous' is 'selfish'; 'liberal' and 'selfless' are close in meaning to 'generous'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) started
SSC's key gives 'started': an initiative is started, or launched, and the passage presents SEL as a novel concept that went on to gain momentum. 'Established' goes more naturally with something set up to last, such as an institution or a system, and 'discovered' and 'reckoned' do not fit.

Q.17 · Answer (C) concept
SEL is a new idea, a 'novel concept'; the passage goes on to call it 'this concept'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) interact
The students 'interact', dealing with one another as they learn; the skills named later are speaking, listening and cooperating.

Q.19 · Answer (B) gained
An idea 'gains momentum' when it spreads and grows in influence, as SEL did after Goleman's best seller.

Q.20 · Answer (A) incorporates
SEL 'incorporates', that is includes, the development of the competencies listed.

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